



Sailor's flat cap

The Civil War brought standardization to naval uniforms. Clothes became practical; fabrics repelled dirt and provided protection against the elements.

Unrivaled success

Another legend began life in a Liverpool shipyard as *Hull 290* before sailing for the Azores in July 1864 as the *Enrica*. On August 24, her new captain, the redeployed Raphael Semmes, hoisted the Confederate ensign and commissioned her as CSS *Alabama*.

The *Alabama* was the epitome of the Confederate commerce raider—a three-masted, bark-rigged sloop-of-war, long, sleek, and very fast. She carried eight guns, and, while capable of 13 knots under both steam and sail, made most of her captures under sail alone. In the sea lanes between Newfoundland and Bermuda and through the West Indies into the Gulf of Mexico, the *Alabama* ravaged U.S. merchant shipping. She also hunted along the coasts of Brazil and Africa, and even sailed across the Indian Ocean to Java and Singapore.

A raider usually approached her target flying a British or Dutch ensign, or flag. Only at close range was the Confederate ensign run up. Semmes boarded nearly 450 ships in *Alabama*'s two years at sea,